

Getting around

These creatures normally move slowly but they can move quickly when in danger. They crawl over land and at the bottom of ponds. Newts sometimes swim near the surface of the water.



This North American tiger salamander can grow to 40 cm (15 in).

Meat habits

Salamanders and newts are insect- and worm-eaters who like to eat fresh prey. They find their food using smell and sight. Salamanders have long tongues that flick out to catch prey.



This Mandarin salamander is eating an earthworm.

Egg laying

Eggs are laid in the water, and when they hatch, they look very much like frog tadpoles. Unlike frogs, however, they keep their tails when they grow up and gain legs. They live in the water until adulthood.



Great crested newt

Colourful displays

Many newts and salamanders are brightly coloured. The male sometimes shows off his colours to females when looking for a mate.



These Alpine newts are performing a courtship dance.



Half-formed

Mexican axolotls are salamanders that have never quite changed fully into adults, but have remained half-formed. They live underwater and are sometimes kept as pets.

